

H2BENCH · CALCULATION NOTE

H2Bench sizing calculations

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

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REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.1	2026-09-25	Amish Chadha	First TRL 3 sizing note (electrolyzer and fill, inventory and pressure, fuel cell, energy balance, measurement uncertainty, hood and venting, interlock, water and drier, envelope and mass, cost, logging)

H2Bench sizing calculations

On paper, H2Bench meets nine of its sixteen requirements. **Two are not met:** hydrogen purity at the fuel cell (R9), because electrolyzer oxygen crossover is unknown and there is no deoxidizer, and cost (R14), at \$865 against the \$450 in `project.yaml` and \$15 over the \$850 recommended at TRL 2. **Four are at risk:** inventory at full relief lift (R5, 10.5 L against 10 L), the H2Guard interlock (R8), electrolyzer back-pressure (R10) and mass (R13, 25.2 kg against 25 kg). Setup time (R16) needs hardware to verify. The TRL 2 energy numbers hold: a 17.7 min fill and a 29.0 min discharge return 5.2 Wh of 20.8 Wh, a round trip of 25.1 % on the HHV basis, and students can measure each stage to within 1.8 %.

Every number here is printed by `docs/04-calcs/sizing.py` (run from the repo root: `python docs/04-calcs/sizing.py`), which also writes `docs/04-calcs/results.csv`. The script reads the tank and bench dimensions from `cad/src/model.py` and the costs from `bom/bom.csv`. All values are first-principles estimates; nothing is measured.

■ 1. Assumptions

Table 1. Inputs. All are assumptions for a paper design.

Input	Value	Basis
Gas constants	$R = 8.314 \text{ J/(mol K)}$, $F = 96,485 \text{ C/mol}$, 24.05 L/mol at 20°C and 101.3 kPa ; H_2 HHV 285.83 kJ/mol , LHV 241.83 kJ/mol , $\gamma = 1.41$	Standard values; ideal gas, with a 0.24 % compressibility correction noted at 400 kPa absolute
Electrolyzer	4 cells, 1.95 V per cell, 9 A, Faraday efficiency 95 %; 2.20 V per cell at end of life	HBN-PRC-001; generic 56 cm^2 class cells
Tank	2.000 L internal (inner radius 52 mm, 200.8 mm straight, hemispherical top), 3 mm aluminium wall	<code>cad/src/model.py</code>
Gas volume outside the tank at tank pressure	0.15 L (separator headspace, drier, lines)	Estimate
Pressures	Fill 70 to 300 kPa gauge; relief 350 kPa gauge with 10 % overpressure at full lift; check valve 7 kPa; kept at 20 kPa gauge overnight	HBN-PRC-001, typical relief valve
Temperatures	Lab 20°C ; coldest 15°C ; separator gas 25°C	HBN-PRB-001
Storage loss	2 % of the hydrogen made per cycle	Estimate, to be measured
Fuel cell	13 cells, 0.60 V at 1.5 A (7.8 V, 11.7 W), fuel utilization 95 %, 0.9 W fan and controls; 0.18 L/min at full output; 45 to 55 kPa gauge supply; 99.995 % purity	Listing for the 12 W class (Fuel Cell Store , checked 2026-09-25)
Measurement	Transducer 0.25 % of 600 kPa full scale; thermistor $\pm 1 \text{ K}$; tank volume $\pm 1 \text{ %}$ by water fill; power $\pm 1 \text{ %}$	HBN-REQ-001 R1
Room and hood	30 m^3 room; $60 \text{ m}^3/\text{h}$ through the canopy duct	Assumed hood share of H2Guard's $150 \text{ m}^3/\text{h}$ continuous exhaust (HGD-PRC-001)
H2Guard	Warning 0.4 % vol (10 % LFL), trip 1.0 % vol (25 % LFL); trip to valve closed 1.1 s	HGD-REQ-001 R2 to R4, HGD-PRC-001 (TRL 2 estimates)
Drier	50 g silica gel, 10 % usable water uptake	Typical indicating gel at low humidity
Budget	\$450 in <code>project.yaml</code> ; \$850 recommended at TRL 2, awaiting Amish	HBN-DDR-001 item 9

■ 2. Electrolyzer and fill (R2, R3, R10)

The stack draws $7.8 \text{ V} \times 9 \text{ A} = \mathbf{70.2 \text{ W}}$ (79 W with aged cells at 2.20 V), inside the 100 W limit (R3) and the 30 V, 10 A supply. Faraday's law gives $1.772 \times 10^{-4} \text{ mol/s}$, or **256 mL/min** at 20°C . Filling the 2.000 L tank from 70 to 300 kPa gauge takes 0.1887 mol (4.54 L at 20°C and 101.3 kPa), so the fill lasts **1,065 s (17.7 min)** and uses **20.77 Wh**. The hydrogen holds 14.99 Wh (HHV): an electrolyzer efficiency of **72.2 %** (voltage efficiency 75.9 %, Faraday efficiency 95 %). The stack gives off about 19.5 W of heat.

The electrolyzer compresses its own hydrogen. The Nernst term at 300 kPa gauge is **17.4 mV per cell**, 0.89 % of the cell voltage, so no compressor is needed.

Back-pressure (R10). The membrane must hold the tank pressure plus the check valve cracking pressure over the oxygen side: **307 kPa** in normal filling, **357 kPa** when the relief valve starts to lift and 392 kPa at full lift. R10's 300 kPa target is therefore too low to cover a relief event, and no generic stack rating is in hand. At risk. A 310 kPa gauge cut of the supply (HBN-DDR-001 item 13) would keep the relief valve as a backup only.

■ 3. Inventory and pressure (R5, R6, R7)

Table 2. Hydrogen held, expressed at 20 °C and 101.3 kPa.

State	Hydrogen
Tank at 300 kPa gauge	0.3293 mol, 7.92 L, 0.664 g
Tank and lines at 300 kPa gauge	8.52 L
Tank and lines at relief set, 350 kPa gauge	9.58 L (9.74 L at 15 °C)
Tank and lines at full relief lift (385 kPa gauge) and 15 °C	10.50 L

The TRL 2 note gave 7.9 L "at the relief setting"; that is the tank alone at the working pressure. At the relief set point the inventory is 9.6 L, which still meets R5, but at full relief lift on a cold day it is 10.5 L. **R5 is at risk.** A relief set at 329 kPa gauge or less keeps even the full-lift case under 10 L; 325 kPa gauge is proposed (HBN-DDR-001 item 13).

Pressure parts (R6). Working 300 kPa gauge, relief 350 kPa gauge. The modeled vessel (110 mm outside diameter, 3 mm aluminium wall) has a hoop stress of 17.8 MPa at its 1 MPa rating and 71.3 MPa at four times that, against a 6061-T6 yield of 276 MPa. Stored pressure energy is **646 J** at 300 kPa gauge (776 J at 350 kPa gauge), by isentropic expansion to atmosphere. Stored chemical energy is 94 kJ (HHV), 80 kJ (LHV). Met.

Room release (R7). The relief-set inventory mixed into a 30 m³ room gives **0.032 % by volume, 0.80 % of the lower flammable limit**; the worst case is 0.035 %. Met by a wide margin. H2Guard's proposed inventory rule (1 % of room volume, 300 L for 30 m³, HGD-REQ-001 R9) is met thirtyfold.

■ 4. Fuel cell and discharge (R2, R4)

Thirteen cells at 0.60 V and 1.5 A give **11.7 W gross and 10.8 W net** after 0.9 W for the fan and controls, which meets R4 with a 0.8 W margin. At 0.58 V per cell the net is 10.4 W; at 0.55 V it falls to 9.8 W, below target. The stack reacts 146 mL/min and, at 95 % utilization, draws **154 mL/min**, inside the listed 0.18 L/min at full output. (The TRL 2 table's 146 mL/min was the reacted flow.)

After 2 % storage loss, 0.1850 mol is available, which runs the fuel cell for **1,739 s (29.0 min)** and delivers **5.22 Wh**. Net fuel cell efficiency is 35.5 % (HHV) or 42.0 % (LHV), consistent with the 40 % system efficiency listed for the 12 W class. About 18.7 W of heat and purge loss leaves the stack. The full cycle runs for **46.7 min**, inside the 60 min of R2. Met.

■ 5. Energy balance

Table 3. Energy per lesson cycle, HHV basis. These values drive .

Stage	Energy	Loss
Electricity in	20.8 Wh	
Hydrogen made	15.0 Wh	Electrolyzer heat 5.8 Wh
After storage	14.7 Wh	Leaks and purges 0.3 Wh
Fuel cell net DC	5.2 Wh	Fuel cell heat, purge and fan 9.5 Wh

The round trip is **25.1 %** (HHV basis), just below the 27.4 to 48 % range published for power-to-hydrogen-to-power ([Oxford Institute for Energy Studies, 2025](#)), as expected at 12 W scale. Each fill splits 3.40 g of water and vents 2.27 L of oxygen.

■ 6. Measurement uncertainty (R1)

Hydrogen is counted from pressure and temperature before and after each stage: $n = PV/(RT)$.

Table 4. Standard uncertainty ($k = 1$) of the hydrogen made per fill.

Source	Contribution
Pressure, 1.5 kPa per reading, two readings	0.92 %
Temperature, ± 1 K, two readings	0.65 %
Tank volume, ± 1 %	1.0 %
Combined	1.51 %

The thermistor is bonded to the tank wall, so the gas temperature matters. During the fill the flow work into the tank heats the gas about 0.95 K above the wall, and the gas settles to the wall with a 15 s time constant; readings are taken 2 min after the fill ends. With power measured to ± 1 %, the stage efficiencies carry: electrolyzer 1.8 %, storage 1.0 %, fuel cell 1.8 %, round trip 1.4 % and Faraday efficiency 1.8 %. All are within the ± 5 % of R1. Met.

■ 7. Hood, venting and interlock (R8, R15, R16)

Hood. At 60 m³/h (1,000 L/min) the 100 mm duct runs at 2.12 m/s. The electrolyzer's full output leaking into the hood gives only 0.026 % by volume at the duct. A leak must exceed 4.0 L/min to reach H2Guard's warning at the duct and 10 L/min to trip it. Small leaks are diluted by the extraction; the sensor at the high point catches large ones and a stopped fan (HGD-REQ-001 R5).

Venting. Venting the tank and lines from 300 to 20 kPa gauge releases 5.94 L. A needle valve set for 3.0 min (an effective orifice of about 0.16 mm) gives a peak of 3.50 L/min, or 0.35 % by volume at the duct (8.7 % of LFL), just under H2Guard's 0.4 % warning. At a constant flow, a vent shorter than 89 s would reach the warning. The end-of-day vent after a discharge (70 to 20 kPa gauge) is only 1.06 L. The 3.0 min vent meets the 5 min shutdown part of R16; setup time needs a walk-through with hardware, so **R16 is not verifiable at TRL 3**.

Interlock (R8). From H2Guard's TRL 2 figures, the trip reaches a closed valve and a dead supply in about 1.1 s (comparator and relay 0.1 s, solenoid 1.0 s), inside 2 s; the electrolyzer makes only 4.7 mL of hydrogen in that time. But H2Guard is itself at TRL 2, its valve is a 24 V part while H2Bench's tank solenoid is 12 V, and whether its relay can break the 9 A DC supply line is not specified. **At risk.**

Guard (R15). The rod guard clears the tank shell by 18 mm, and the relief and vent lines run to the canopy in the model. Met by design review.

■ 8. Water, drier and purity (R9, R11)

Gas leaving the separator at 25 °C carries 0.79 to 1.85 % water vapour by mole, depending on tank pressure: about 0.045 g of water per fill. 50 g of silica gel at 10 % uptake lasts about **110 fills** before its color changes. The drier removes water, but PEM stacks also pass some oxygen across the membrane, and there is no deoxidizer. The fuel cell listing asks for 99.995 % or better. **R9 is not met** until the stack supplier states the oxygen content or the fuel cell supplier accepts the gas. Water quality (R11) is met by the mixed-bed resin and conductivity check.

■ 9. Envelope and mass (R13)

The model's envelope above the lab table is **900 x 450 x 755 mm**, inside 1,000 x 500 x 800 mm.

Table 5. Mass estimate.

Item	Mass (kg)
1 Frame (3.6 m of 20 x 20 mm extrusion) and 12 mm HDPE deck	1.80 + 4.62
2 Back panel, 3 mm aluminium composite	1.95
3 Canopy, posts and duct collar	1.89
4 Bench power supply	3.00
5 Reservoir (filled) and deionizer	0.80
6 Electrolyzer stack	3.00
7 and 8 Separator, drier, check valve and arrestor	0.70
9 Tank shell (from the model) and guard	0.80 + 1.40
10 and 11 Manifold, regulator and solenoid	1.20
12 Fuel cell (275 g listed) with stand and controller	0.50
13 and 14 Load, lamp, meters and display	0.70
15 H2Guard parts on the bench	1.50
16 and 17 Tubing, wiring and hardware	1.30
Total	25.2 (22.2 without the supply)

The TRL 2 estimate of 18 kg was low; the HDPE deck and the electrolyzer dominate. At 25.2 kg against 25 kg, **R13 is at risk**. It is met if the bench supply is carried separately, or with a 10 mm deck (saving about 0.8 kg).

■ 10. Cost (R14)

The 18-line BOM totals **\$865** (H2Guard excluded). Without the bench supply it is \$800, and without the supply and the plug-in RCD (where the socket is already protected) \$780. Against the \$450 in `project.yaml` the full kit is \$415 over; against the \$850 recommended at TRL 2 (awaiting Amish) it is \$15 over, while the kit without the supply is \$50 under. The two stacks are \$400, 46 % of the total. **Not met.** The TRL 2 total of \$845 rises by \$20 for the RCD line.

■ 11. Logging (R12)

One cycle is 2,804 s, so a 1 Hz log with 10 channels is 2,804 rows, about 224 kB of CSV. Met by design review.

■ 12. Results

Table 6. Results against HBN-REQ-001 v0.3. Written to `docs/04-calcs/results.csv`.

ID	Value	Target	Status
R1	Worst stage 1.8 % (hydrogen per fill 1.5 %, power 1 %)	Each stage within ± 5 % relative	Met
R2	17.7 min fill + 29.0 min discharge = 46.7 min	60 min or less	Met
R3	70.2 W (79 W with aged cells)	100 W or less	Met
R4	10.8 W net (11.7 W gross); 9.8 W if cells fall to 0.55 V	10 to 50 W	Met
R5	8.5 L at 300 kPa gauge; 9.6 L at relief set; 10.5 L at full relief lift and 15 °C	10 L or less	At risk
R6	300 kPa gauge working, relief 350 kPa gauge; hoop stress 18 MPa at 1 MPa	300 and 350 kPa gauge or less; vessel 1 MPa or more	Met
R7	0.032 % by volume (0.8 % LFL); 0.035 % worst case	Below 25 % LFL in 30 m ³	Met
R8	1.1 s trip to valve closed, from H2Guard TRL 2 figures; 24 V and 12 V valve mismatch	Supply cut and solenoid closed within 2 s; fan runs	At risk
R9	Water removed; oxygen crossover unknown; no deoxidizer	99.995 % or better	Not met
R10	Needs 307 kPa in filling, 357 kPa at relief set, 392 kPa at full lift; no rating in hand	300 kPa or more over the O2 side	At risk
R11	Mixed-bed resin with conductivity check; 3.4 g water per fill	1 μ S/cm or less	Met
R12	2,804 rows per cycle, about 224 kB	V, I, P, p and T at 1 Hz to CSV	Met
R13	900 x 450 x 755 mm; 25.2 kg (22.2 kg without the supply)	1,000 x 500 mm, 800 mm, 25 kg or less	At risk
R14	\$865 full; \$800 without the supply; \$780 minimum (H2Guard excluded)	\$450 or less (proposed \$850, awaiting Amish)	Not met
R15	Guard clearance 18 mm; relief and vent piped to the canopy	Guard, piped relief, no tool-free fitting	Met
R16	Vent 3.0 min; setup needs a walk-through with hardware	Setup 15 min or less; safe in 5 min or less	Not verifiable at TRL 3

■ 13. Safety

Safety: Hydrogen is flammable from about 4 to 74 % in air and ignites with about 0.02 mJ. These calculations bound the inventory (10.5 L worst case) and the concentration at the duct, but they do not replace H2Guard's detection and interlock, supervision, or a site risk assessment. H2Bench is a research and teaching prototype, not certified laboratory equipment.

Safety: The tank and lines hold up to 776 J of pressure energy at the relief setting. Use only vessels and fittings rated 1 MPa or more for hydrogen, keep the guard in place and never open a pressurized fitting.

Safety: Vent slowly. Venting a full tank in under about 90 s can raise the concentration at the duct past H2Guard's warning level; the needle valve is set for 3 min or more.